

AI Literacy - Printable PDF - Free Preview

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AI Literacy: Understanding, Using, and Questioning Artificial Intelligence

CHAPTER 1

What Is AI Literacy?

AI literacy is the set of knowledge, skills, and habits of judgment that helps people understand, evaluate, use, and participate in decisions about artificial intelligence systems.

Being AI literate does not mean becoming a computer scientist. It means being able to recognize when AI is being used, understand what it can and cannot do, ask good questions, use it responsibly, and help shape how it affects daily life.

AI literacy matters because AI is increasingly present in:

- Education
- Workplaces
- Healthcare
- Media and information systems
- Banking and hiring
- Transportation
- Public services
- Customer support
- Entertainment and social platforms

As AI becomes more common, people need more than access to tools. They need the ability to use those tools wisely.

CHAPTER 2

A Simple Analogy: Learning to Drive a Powerful Car

AI literacy is like learning to drive a powerful car.

You do not need to build the engine. But you do need to understand:

- The controls
- The speed and limits of the vehicle
- The safety rules
- The risks of poor use
- When to slow down
- When to let a human take control
- When conditions require extra caution

AI systems can be useful and powerful, but they still require informed human judgment.

CHAPTER 3

Why AI Literacy Matters

AI can help people write, search, analyze, translate, recommend, predict, summarize, create images, detect patterns, and automate tasks. But AI can also make mistakes, reflect bias, expose private information, or present uncertain outputs as if they are certain.

Broad AI literacy supports:

1. Informed Participation

People can better understand how AI affects their communities, workplaces, schools, and public services.

2. Safer Adoption

Users are more likely to notice risks, question outputs, protect personal information, and avoid overreliance.

3. More Equitable Outcomes

When more people understand AI, more people can participate in decisions about how it is designed, used, regulated, and evaluated.

4. Better Everyday Decisions

People can decide when AI is helpful, when it is inappropriate, and when human expertise is necessary.

CHAPTER 4

The Core Parts of AI Literacy

AI literacy includes four connected abilities:

4.1 1. Understanding AI

An AI-literate person can explain, in simple terms, what AI systems do.

This includes knowing that AI systems often work by identifying patterns in data and generating outputs based on those patterns. AI does not "understand" in the same way humans do, even when its responses sound fluent or confident.

Key questions:

- What is this AI system designed to do?
 - What kind of data might it use?
 - Is it making a prediction, recommendation, classification, or generated response?
 - Is a human reviewing the result?
-

4.2 2. Evaluating AI

AI outputs should not be accepted automatically. AI-literate users learn to evaluate results carefully.

This includes checking whether an output is:

- Accurate
- Relevant
- Current
- Fair
- Complete
- Transparent enough to understand
- Appropriate for the situation

Key questions:

- Could this answer be wrong?
 - What evidence supports it?
 - Are there missing perspectives?
 - Could the system be biased?
 - Should I verify this with another trusted source?
-

4.3 3. Using AI Responsibly

AI literacy includes practical skill. People should know how to use AI tools effectively while understanding their limits.

Responsible use includes:

- Giving clear instructions
- Checking outputs before relying on them
- Avoiding the sharing of sensitive personal information
- Understanding that AI can produce false or misleading content
- Knowing when human expertise is required
- Using AI as support, not as a substitute for responsibility

Key questions:

- Am I using this tool for a task it is suited to?
 - What information am I putting into the system?
 - Who could be affected by this output?
 - Do I need expert review?
-

4.4 4. Participating in Decisions About AI

AI affects society, not just individual users. AI literacy helps people participate in decisions about how AI should be used in schools, workplaces, healthcare, government, media, and public life.

This includes asking about:

- Privacy
- Bias
- Transparency
- Accountability

- Human oversight
- Safety
- Fair access
- The right to question or appeal AI-assisted decisions

Key questions:

- Who benefits from this AI system?
 - Who might be harmed?
 - Who is responsible if something goes wrong?
 - Can people understand or challenge the decision?
 - Is there meaningful human oversight?
-

CHAPTER 5

What AI Can Do Well

AI can be useful for many tasks, especially when the task involves patterns, language, classification, or large amounts of information.

Examples include:

- Summarizing long documents
- Drafting text
- Translating languages
- Finding patterns in data
- Generating study questions
- Supporting brainstorming
- Organizing information
- Assisting with accessibility tools
- Helping detect unusual activity or trends

AI can be especially helpful when used as a first draft, assistant, or support tool.

CHAPTER 6

What AI Cannot Reliably Do

AI has important limits. It can produce results that look polished but are still wrong.

AI may struggle with:

- Understanding real-world context
- Explaining how it reached a result
- Knowing whether information is current
- Recognizing its own mistakes
- Handling unusual cases
- Making moral or legal judgments
- Representing all groups fairly
- Protecting privacy unless systems are designed and used carefully

AI should not be treated as automatically objective, neutral, or correct.

CHAPTER 7

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